

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Chronology and evidence discipline

c. 550 CE -> Gupta concentration weakens; regional houses multiply

606 CE -> Harsha succeeds amid the Rajyavardhana-Rajyashri crisis

c. 630s -> Pulakeshin II checks northern expansion near the Narmada

637 CE -> Shashanka dies; eastern competition continues

647-648 CE -> Harsha dies without a durable successor empire

SOURCES: Bana + Xuanzang + charters + coins + Aihole + archaeology

RULE: triangulate literary praise, pilgrim report and rival inscription.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Post-Gupta political landscape

NORTH-WEST / WEST -> Maitrakas and other regional powers

MIDDLE GANGA -> Later Guptas + Maukharis

THANESAR-KANNAUJ -> Pushyabhutis under Harsha

GAUDA -> Shashanka

KAMARUPA -> Bhaskaravarman

DECCAN LIMIT -> Badami Chalukyas under Pulakeshin II

VERDICT: several strong regional states replaced one uncontested imperial centre.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Pushyabhuti rise and Kannauj shift

PRABHAKARAVARDHANA -> stronger Thanesar line

RAJYASHRI + GRAHAVARMAN -> Maukhari marriage bridge

Grahavarman killed -> Rajyavardhana campaigns -> accession crisis

HARSHAVARDHANA -> rescue + consolidation + Maukhari inheritance

THANESAR -> KANNAUJ

MECHANISM: kinship + strategy + Ganga-doab access + sovereignty prestige

LIMIT: Harsha inherited a crisis, not a ready-made pan-Indian empire.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Harsha's graded sovereignty and Narmada limit

DIRECT CORE -> Haryana, much of UP and parts of Bihar

PROBABLE REACH -> selected eastern territories including Odisha

WIDER ALLEGIANCE -> Kamarupa, Valabhi and other rulers in varying degrees

HARD LIMIT -> Pulakeshin II and the Narmada frontier

BANA / XUANZANG -> prestige-heavy northern view

AIHOLE -> rival Chalukya check

VERDICT: major north Indian hegemon; not a stable all-India emperor.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Administration, revenue and samanta order

KING / MOBILE CAMP

- > bhukti provincial units
- > vishaya district units
- > officers, villages and revenue collectors
- > samantas and feudatory rulers

REVENUE: bhaga + bhoga + kara + hiranya

ARMY: royal forces reinforced by subordinate chiefs

TENSION: delegated reach could integrate territory and enlarge local autonomy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Eastern India regional state formation

BENGAL / GAUDA -> Shashanka, Pundravardhana, Samatata, gold issues

ODISHA -> regional lines, charters, agraharas and expanding settlement

ASSAM -> Kamarupa, Varman line and Bhaskaravarman

COMMON PROCESS -> Sanskrit charters + fiscal districts + military camps
+ land rights + agrarian expansion

DIFFERENCE -> chronology, ecology and political scale varied sharply

RULE: do not begin eastern state history only with the Palas.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Land grants and agrarian transformation

FALLOW / CULTIVATED LAND + ROYAL CLAIM

|

purchase, charter, boundary record and tax remission

|

Brahmana / monastery / religious beneficiary

|

cultivation + literacy + fiscal reallocation + landed hierarchy

EASTERN PLATES -> local scribes, merchants, landholders and cultivators

LIMIT: elite charters reveal process more clearly than peasant experience.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Economy and urban change debate

DECLINE EVIDENCE -> contraction of selected older towns and coin changes

REORGANISATION EVIDENCE:

- |-- Kannauj rises as a strategic centre
- |-- eastern land was purchased with gold in selected records
- |-- new camps, grants, monasteries and regional capitals appear
- `-- routes and markets persist unevenly

NALANDA -> institutional concentration, not proof of universal prosperity

VERDICT: decline in older forms coexisted with regional creation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Religion, assemblies and political theatre

EARLY LINE -> solar associations

HARSHACHARITA / CHARTERS -> Shaiva idioms

XUANZANG -> strong Buddhist patronage

KANNAUJ ASSEMBLY -> debate, hierarchy and royal display

PRAYAGA ASSEMBLY -> Buddha + Shiva + Sun across successive days

CHARITY -> piety + redistribution + sovereignty performance

VERDICT: overlapping royal affiliations, not one exclusive religious label.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Nalanda and trans-Asian learning networks

ROYAL / LANDED SUPPORT -> monastic infrastructure

INDIAN TEACHERS <-> Nalanda study and debate <-> ASIAN PILGRIMS

XUANZANG -> study, travel and carriage of Buddhist texts to China

YIJING -> comparative evidence and numerical caution

UNESCO SITE -> surviving viharas, temples, art and planned layout

SECURE CLAIM: major scholastic network

CAUTION: famous enrolment figures are estimates, not census data.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Source criticism and historiography

BANA -> accession and court world | literary praise / elite focus
XUANZANG -> routes, Nalanda, assemblies | pilgrim purpose / later writing
CHARTERS -> offices, grants, taxes | selective documentary survival
COINS -> rulers, economy, symbols | circulation is not a border map
AIHOLE -> Narmada limit | rival prashasti and exaggeration
SHARMA -> structural transition | avoid universal decline
METHOD: claim -> source -> corroboration -> limitation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Post-Gupta answer spine

OPEN -> c. 550-750 as contraction plus regional reorganisation

POLITY -> Pushyabhuti rise + Kannauj + graded sovereignty

LIMIT -> Pulakeshin II and the Narmada

EAST -> Gauda + Kamarupa + Odisha/Bengal grants

STRUCTURE -> samantas + land rights + agrarian change

CULTURE -> assemblies + Nalanda + source triangulation

CLOSE -> Harsha briefly reunited the north while regional states deepened.